I also attended, incognito, a public meeting of the Sikh Forum held at the Constitution Club of India in New Delhi in November 2017 to mark the thirty-third anniversary of the anti-Sikh pogrom of 1984. I deliberately reached late and sat in the last row. After senior journalist Saba Naqvi and journalist, editor and academic Siddharth Varadarajan had spoken, founder-member of the Forum, Professor Amarjit Singh Narang, made a significant observation in his concluding remarks. He said that if it was somehow not possible to punish those guilty of the 1984 pogrom despite the plethora of evidence against them, it was better not to prolong the agony of the concerned family members and the overall Sikh community. He said Sikhs were prepared to forget and forgive the Congress party, if the party apologized for its role in abetting and organizing that massacre. But for that, leaders of the Congress party insisted on evidence in support of the charge.

'Where from should we produce that evidence?' lamented Professor Narang. I left the meeting at that point. While driving home it struck me that I actually have the requisite knowledge about how it all started in 1980, how the operation was carried out and who were the persons responsible for what followed. I had been carrying this burden for almost forty years. It was time to transfer it into a book, in the hope that it might somehow help bring closure to one of the darkest chapters of post-independent India's history.